
PAPERBOY

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OpenAI's annualised revenue turns out to be about \$20bn smaller than the figure investors had been underwriting, and the AI complex had its worst day since August.

AI

OpenAI's revenue is about \$20bn smaller than the number everyone was using

WHAT HAPPENED

The Financial Times reported on 8 October that OpenAI has told prospective investors its annualised revenue is "approaching \$50 billion" - against the \$68bn to \$70bn figure that had circulated since late summer. Accounting professor Francine McKenna, in her newsletter The Dig, says part of the gap is definitional: Anthropic books the full customer payment when a cloud partner resells its models and expenses the partner's cut, while OpenAI books only its own share. The claim that the higher figure had been grossed up for comparability comes from the FT's anonymous sources, not from McKenna. Neither company has commented on the record. ([Axios](#))

WHAT IT MEANS

A leak of investor materials, not a disclosure, and the prior figure is itself contested - \$68bn in one telling, about \$70bn in another, and reported in late September rather than two months ago. But the number people had been pricing the AI trade off was wrong by the market capitalisation of a large public company, and wrong in the direction that matters.

WATCH NEXT

Whether OpenAI puts a figure on the record. An Anthropic prospectus has leaked; no S-1 has been filed.

Google gives its enterprise agent an email address and an audit trail

WHAT HAPPENED

At a Google Cloud event on 8 October, Google put a single task-executing agent inside Gemini for business customers. It plans work, calls custom tools, delegates to subagents and reports into a "tasks inbox". The design choice worth noting is identity: the agent gets its own Workspace account with an email address and calendar access, is summoned by tagging it, emailing it, sharing a document with it or adding it to a group chat, and every action it takes is logged under its own name. Thomas Kurian said customers can give it "objectives, not just instructions." No price was disclosed. ([TechCrunch](#))

WHAT IT MEANS

Agents have so far been features inside products. Giving one a directory entry and an audit log makes it an org-chart problem instead - who it reports to, what it is allowed to approve, who answers for what it does. It picks its own model by default but can be pinned to one, including Anthropic's Claude, which is a real concession from Google.

WATCH NEXT

Pricing, which is unannounced beyond "flexible spending options" and spend caps. Consumers get the agent later.

GlobalFoundries will make TSMC's interposers in upstate New York

WHAT HAPPENED

GlobalFoundries announced on 8 October a \$2bn manufacturing agreement with TSMC, with an initial five-year term, to add capacity at its Malta, New York fab for silicon interposers - including embedded deep-trench capacitor components - feeding TSMC's CoWoS advanced-packaging flow. Volume production ramps in the first half of 2028. GF names TSMC as the counterparty itself; capex, installed capacity and how the \$2bn breaks down are all undisclosed. Ed Kaste, GF's senior vice president of CMOS Business, said the agreement means "we are creating a secure, scalable source of essential advanced-packaging elements". GFS closed at \$49.36, up 2.68%. ([GF release](#))

WHAT IT MEANS

The interposer - the silicon slab that wires a GPU die to its memory stacks - has been one of the hardest bottlenecks in the accelerator supply chain, and it has been made almost entirely in Taiwan. This makes GF a subcontractor inside TSMC's packaging line rather than a competing foundry. Smaller ambition, paying work, and a domestic source for the part nobody could second-source.

WATCH NEXT

TSMC's Q3 results on 15 October for any CoWoS capacity language.

The AI hardware complex had its worst day since August

WHAT HAPPENED

The OpenAI revenue report repriced the whole AI capex chain on Thursday. The Nasdaq Composite fell 1.25% to 27,193.34 - its steepest one-day drop since 18 August - while the Dow rose 51.77 points to 51,231.64 and the S&P 500 fell 0.47% to 7,765.36. Nvidia closed at \$230.48, down 2.94%, for a market capitalisation of \$5.57tn. Intel fell 5.34% to \$107.08 and Oracle 5.48% to \$135.69. SiliconANGLE reported CoreWeave down 8%, Super Micro about 5%, and AMD and Broadcom 4% each; those four are single-outlet. The Russell 2000 was essentially flat.

WHAT IT MEANS

A rotation, not a risk-off. The Dow finishing higher while the Nasdaq lost more than a percent is the market separating the AI capex trade from everything else - which is what you would expect if the repricing is about one customer's revenue rather than about rates or growth. Note what was not hit: memory. Samsung's guidance held the narrative all week.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the chip names hold through TSMC on 15 October.

The 30-year cleared 31bp higher than September, and Waller said more hikes are coming

WHAT HAPPENED

Treasury's \$22bn reopening of the 30-year bond on 8 October drew a 5.618% high yield - 31 basis points above the 10 September reopening's 5.308% - on a 2.54 bid-to-cover against 2.61 last month. Primary dealers took only 6.79% of the \$21.94bn accepted competitively, indirect bidders 72.32%. The curve rallied anyway: the 30-year par yield fell 7bp to 5.60%, the 10-year 6bp to 5.22%. Separately, Governor Christopher Waller told the Istanbul Economic Forum that if the data continue as expected, "I anticipate additional hikes to support a timelier return of inflation to our 2 percent goal," adding they "do not need to come at consecutive meetings." ([Fed](#))

WHAT IT MEANS

Dealers barely absorbed any of a very cheap long bond, which means real money took it without complaint. And the Fed's most explicit hawk has put a sequence on the record rather than a maybe: sixteen of the eighteen September dots carried at least one more hike, four of them two.

WATCH NEXT

September CPI on Wednesday 14 October, PPI 15 October, FOMC 27-28 October. Futures put about 85% on at least one hike by December.

Oil up 4% on Iran, then down on a social-media post, then up again

WHAT HAPPENED

November WTI settled at \$91.49, up 3.64%, and December Brent at \$104.28, up 4.07%, on 8 October. Two supply threats collided: reports that Washington had completed options for strikes on Iran, and Hurricane Isaias, which shut in about 1.3m barrels a day - roughly 62% of Gulf oil output, per the Marine Minerals Administration. Prices retraced hard intraday after Trump ruled out a strike before the midterms, then recovered into the settle.

WHAT IT MEANS

Brent above \$100 is a risk premium, not a physical shortage, and the intraday round trip on one social-media post is the proof. The problem is that the Fed said in its September minutes it treats elevated energy prices as a reason to tighten - which converts a geopolitical bid into a monetary one.

WATCH NEXT

Isaias was a Category 2 with 110mph winds and strengthening early Friday. Restart timing on the Gulf shut-ins.

PepsiCo beat on revenue and cut its profit guidance

WHAT HAPPENED

PepsiCo reported its 12-week third quarter, ended 5 September, before the open on 8 October: net revenue up 5.6% to \$25.27bn, GAAP earnings per share of \$2.23 (up 17%), core earnings per share of \$2.34 (up 2%). It cut full-year core EPS growth guidance to 2.5%-3.5%, from the low end of a 5%-7% range. Ramon Laguarta said "additional structural cost reduction actions are being identified and will be implemented in the coming months". Separately, initial jobless claims came in at 197,000 for the week to 3 October. ([8-K](#))

WHAT IT MEANS

Revenue fine, profit not: the shape of a company absorbing input costs it cannot pass through. The claims print is the other half of Waller's argument - a labour market this tight gives the committee no reason to wait.

WATCH NEXT

The big banks open Q3 earnings season next week.

STARTUPS

Manus raises over \$500m, six months after Beijing unwound its Meta deal

WHAT HAPPENED

Butterfly Effect, parent of the Chinese AI agent company Manus, said in a WeChat post on 8 October that it had raised more than \$500m, co-led by Boyu Capital and IDG Capital, with Tencent, HSG (formerly Sequoia China) and ZhenFund participating. No valuation was disclosed and the company declined to discuss one; it was reported in September to be in talks at \$4bn, unconfirmed. It is the first round since Chinese authorities ordered Meta's \$2bn acquisition, announced in December 2025, unwound in April over concern about AI researchers moving West. Manus resumed independent operations in August. ([TechCrunch](#))

WHAT IT MEANS

The unwind was read at the time as a regulator destroying a company's exit. Six months on it has half a billion dollars of domestic capital and is reportedly weighing a Hong Kong listing - roughly the outcome Beijing was after.

WATCH NEXT

A confirmed valuation, and the Hong Kong IPO talk.

The AI leaderboard raises \$200m at \$3.1bn

WHAT HAPPENED

Arena, which began as a 2023 research project at UC Berkeley and runs the LMArena crowdsourced model leaderboard, announced a \$200m Series B at a \$3.1bn valuation on 8 October, co-led by Lightspeed Venture Partners and Khosla Ventures, with Salesforce Ventures, Dell Technologies Capital, a16z and Felicis among the others. Pre- or post-money is not stated. Its January Series A was \$150m at \$1.7bn post-money, so the figure has nearly doubled in nine months. The company says it had roughly \$30m of annualised revenue at that round and reached a \$100m annualised run-rate in June. TechCrunch is the only source. ([TechCrunch](#))

WHAT IT MEANS

Arena sells evaluation services to the labs whose models it ranks - a conflict it has not resolved and investors have decided not to mind. The bet is that as models converge on static benchmarks, which Arena says "break down once models recognize they're being tested", a crowd-voted ranking becomes the scarce asset.

WATCH NEXT

Whether any lab publicly challenges the leaderboard's neutrality now that it is a \$3bn vendor.

Voltus takes \$225m for grid flexibility, with Vitol co-leading

WHAT HAPPENED

Voltus, which aggregates distributed energy resources and bids them into electricity markets, announced an oversubscribed \$225m Series D on 8 October led by Generation Investment Management and co-led by Activate Capital and Vitol, with Broadscale Group, Climate Investment, NGP and Ajax Strategies among the others. No valuation was disclosed. Chief executive Dana Guernsey said "electricity is now the constraint behind almost every major ambition we have, but it doesn't have to be." ([Release](#))

WHAT IT MEANS

Demand response is the cheapest capacity on the grid and the hardest to sell, because nobody holds a ribbon-cutting for a megawatt that went unused. Vitol co-leading is the signal - a physical commodity trader buying flexibility as an asset class, not as a climate position.

WATCH NEXT

Voltus says it wants 20GW on the platform by 2030; it has not said what the base is.

A Trump appointee signals he will permanently lift the White House press ban

WHAT HAPPENED

At a hearing on 8 October, US District Judge Timothy Kelly, a Trump appointee, heard argument on making permanent his 24 September temporary restraining order, which blocked the White House from excluding CNN, Politico and MS NOW. He has not ruled, and said he would decide by Tuesday; the order was extended to then after a scheduling delay. Kelly said the facts did not suggest a "hair-on-fire" need to protect national security. Theodore Boutrous, for the outlets, called the ban "textbook retaliation". Justice Department lawyer Michael Velchik argued the binding D.C. Circuit precedents were wrongly decided. ([Courthouse News](#))

WHAT IT MEANS

The government is not really contesting the First Amendment question in front of Kelly; it is arguing the controlling precedents are wrong. That concedes the district court and plays for the appeal, which makes an adverse ruling on Tuesday the expected outcome rather than a surprise.

WATCH NEXT

Kelly's ruling, promised by Tuesday; no docket number has surfaced. And in *ABC v. FCC*, 1:26-cv-02902, argued 6 October, no ruling from Judge AliKhan is locatable yet.

Florida asks a court to make Meta rebuild its teen products

WHAT HAPPENED

Florida Attorney General James Uthmeier filed for a temporary injunction against Meta on 7 October, confirmed by his own office. JURIST reports the filing was made in the Circuit Court for Florida's Sixth Judicial Circuit under the state's Deceptive and Unfair Trade Practices Act; no case number has surfaced. The state asks the court to restrict children's access, surface safety information, improve child-sexual-exploitation reporting and disable features that drive excessive teen use, and alleges Mark Zuckerberg's congressional testimony was inconsistent with Meta's own internal research. Florida stayed out of the 47-state, \$18bn August settlement, saying it "did not go far enough to protect children". Meta has not responded. ([AG release](#))

WHAT IT MEANS

Asking for product-design orders rather than money is the harder ask and the more consequential one. A settlement is a cost of doing business; an injunction that changes what Instagram does for every teenager in Florida is a template other attorneys general copy.

WATCH NEXT

A hearing date, a docket number, and Meta's answer.

The diesel order's clock runs out tomorrow and nothing has been decided

WHAT HAPPENED

The 5 October executive order "Emergency Tax Relief on Diesel Fuel" gives the Treasury Secretary five days - expiring 10 October - to determine whether existing law lets him defer the diesel excise tax incurred between 5 October and 31 December, and to direct the IRS not to penalise on-highway use of dyed diesel. As of Friday morning no determination, notice or guidance exists: neither Treasury's press releases nor the IRS newsroom carries anything on fuel. ([EO text](#))

WHAT IT MEANS

An order directing an agency to decide something has not decided it. The only relief operating today is dyed diesel running on highways, and even that depends on the IRS saying out loud it will not penalise it.

WATCH NEXT

The determination, due tomorrow.

The Nobel Peace Prize goes to the jurist who led the UN's Gaza genocide finding

WHAT HAPPENED

The Norwegian Nobel Committee awarded the 2026 Peace Prize in Oslo on 9 October to Navanethem "Navi" Pillay, 85, the South African lawyer who was UN High Commissioner for Human Rights from 2008 to 2014, "for her efforts to promote peace and international law". She is the sole laureate. She was a judge and then president of the International Criminal Tribunal for Rwanda, and sits now on the International Court of Justice in the Myanmar genocide case. In 2025 she chaired the UN inquiry that found Israel had committed genocide in Gaza, a finding Israel rejects. ([Al Jazeera](#))

WHAT IT MEANS

Committee chair Jorgen Watne Frydnes made the reasoning explicit: "An international legal system in which war criminals are held to account and the victims of abuse see justice served is a precondition for a peaceful world." Giving the prize to the author of the Gaza finding is not a neutral gesture, and the committee did not intend it as one.

WATCH NEXT

An Israeli response; none by Friday morning. The ceremony is 10 December.

A glide bomb hit two buses in Kramatorsk; at least 33 dead

WHAT HAPPENED

A Russian glide bomb - the attribution is Ukrainian police's - struck two city buses on a street in Kramatorsk, Donetsk region, on 8 October. Ukraine's State Emergency Service put the toll at at least 33 killed by Thursday evening, up from an initial 12 at midday; Donetsk regional head Vadym Filashkin counted 22 injured. Both are Ukrainian state counts; Zelenskyy said the toll might rise. Moscow did not comment and denies targeting civilians. ([Al Jazeera](#))

WHAT IT MEANS

Glide bombs are cheap, released from well inside Russian airspace, and far less precise than a missile or an FPV drone - which makes intent unanswerable from the crater alone, and is exactly why they are used. Marco Rubio's response is the thing to notice: "This war needs to end in a negotiated settlement. The sooner, the better." Not a condemnation.

WATCH NEXT

A named Ukrainian retaliation; another toll revision.

Trump rules out an Iran strike before the midterms, in writing

WHAT HAPPENED

Trump posted on Truth Social on 8 October that "we will not be attacking Iran at any time prior to the Midterm Elections" and that the US and Iran "are having productive discussions". It is the first firm statement after a fortnight of anonymous sourcing: the New York Times has Trump asking the Pentagon for options including a roughly three-day campaign; Axios has the Pentagon telling CENTCOM to conclude preparations. Three outlets sourcing separately is not three confirmations: still no congressional notification, no carrier movement, no Pentagon statement on the record. ([Axios](#))

WHAT IT MEANS

A date certain is worth more than a fortnight of sourcing, and oil traded on it within minutes. But it is a floor, not a policy, and it tells Tehran exactly how much time it has.

WATCH NEXT

Pezeshkian said on 9 October that dialogue succeeds only when "devoid of pressure and threat". The midterms are 3 November.

SOURCES

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[TechCrunch](#) - OpenAI's revenue is reportedly \$20 billion less than previously projected

[TechCrunch](#) - Google brings agentic AI to Gemini, starting with businesses

[GlobalFoundries](#) - U.S.-based supply of advanced packaging elements for TSMC

[SiliconANGLE](#) - AI stocks crumble on report of OpenAI's annualized revenue

[Nvidia](#) share price and market capitalisation

[Treasury](#) - auction results, 8 October 2026

[Treasury](#) - daily par yield curve, October 2026

[Federal Reserve](#) - Waller, 'The Signaling Value of the Summary of Economic Projections'

[Investing.com](#) - Brent crude historical settlements

[Rigzone](#) - Gulf platform evacuations, Hurricane Isaias

[PepsiCo](#) Q3 2026 earnings release (8-K Exhibit 99.1)

[US Department of Labor](#) - weekly unemployment insurance claims

[TechCrunch](#) - China's Manus raises over \$500M

[TechCrunch](#) - Arena nearly doubles valuation to \$3.1B

[Voltus](#) - \$225 million Series D

[Courthouse News](#) - Judge likely to end White House ban on CNN, Politico and MS NOW

[Florida Attorney General](#) - files for temporary injunction against Meta

[JURIST](#) - Florida seeks injunction requiring Meta to overhaul minor safety

[White House](#) - Executive Order, Emergency Tax Relief on Diesel Fuel

[Al Jazeera](#) - 2026 Nobel Peace Prize awarded to Navi Pillay

[South China Morning Post - Navi Pillay wins 2026 Nobel Peace Prize](#)

[Al Jazeera - Russian attack on Kramatorsk](#)

[Kyiv Post - Kramatorsk glide bomb strike](#)

[Axios - Trump says no Iran strikes before the midterms](#)

[Arab News - Saudia pilot killed in attack on Riyadh airport](#)

[Brasil de Fato - Datafolha second round: Flavio 49%, Lula 45%](#)